University of Hyderabad
(AC - 97)

Minutes of the 97th meeting of the Academic Council held on 24th April, 2026 at 10:00 A.M. in the School of Life Sciences Auditorium, University of Hyderabad Campus, Hyderabad-500 046.

Members present:

Prof. J. Anuradha	Vice-Chancellor i/c & Chairperson
Dr. Devesh Nigam	Registrar & Ex-Officio Secretary
Shri Thukaram Porika	Controller of Examinations i/c & Convener
DEANS OF THE SCHOOLS	
Prof. Saroj Panigrahi	Mathematics and Statistics
Prof. Siba Kumar Udgata	Computer and Information Sciences
Prof. Nirmal Kumar Viswanathan* In charge	Physics
Prof. Anand Kumar Kondapi	Life Sciences
Prof. M. T. Ansari	Humanities & Head, Centre for Dalit and Adivasi Studies and Translation & Head, Centre for Buddhist Studies & Head, Centre for Study of Foreign Languages & Centre for Endangered Languages and Mother Tongue Studies (CEL&MTS)
Prof. K. Suneetha Rani	Social Sciences (Head i/c, Centre for Human Rights)
Prof. Debashis Acharya	Economics
Prof. M. Samba Siva Raju	S N School of Arts and Communication
Prof. G.V.R.K. Acharyulu	Management Studies
Prof. Ramesh K. Mishra	Medical Sciences & Head, Centre for Neural and Cognitive Science
HEADS/ DIRECTORS OF THE DEPARTMENTS / CENTRES	
Prof. Sanjay Subodh	Director, Centre for Integrated Studies (CIS) & Chief Proctor

Prof. Samrat L Sabat	CASEST & Director, Research & Development Cell
Prof. V. Chakravarthi	CEOAS
Prof. Sharmistha Banerjee	Biochemistry
Prof. Ragiba Makandar	Plant Sciences
Prof. Kota Arun Kumar	Animal Biology
Prof. M. Venkataramana	Biotechnology and Bioinformatics
Prof. H.A.Nagarajaram	Systems & Computational Biology
Prof. Ramesh K. Mishra	Centre for Neural & Cognitive Sciences
Prof. G. Padmaja	Centre for Psychology & DSW
Prof. Pramod K. Nayar	English
Prof. B. Ananda Sagar	Philosophy
Prof. M. Shyam Rao	Hindi
Prof. P. Ramulu	Telugu
Prof. A.M.Syed Fazlullah	Urdu
Prof. S. Arulmozi	Centre for Applied Linguistics & Translation Studies (CALTS)
Prof. J. Bheemaiah	Centre for Comparative Literature (CCL)
Prof. J.S.R. Prasad	Sanskrit Studies
Prof. Sunita Mishra	Centre for English Language Studies
Prof. K.Y. Ratnam	Political Science
Prof. G. Nagaraju	Sociology
Prof. Romesh Singh	Anthropology
Prof. Sreepati Ramudu	Centre for Study of Social Inclusion
Prof. Vasantha Srinivasa Rao	Centre for Regional Studies
Dr. Joly Puthussery	Centre for Folk Culture Studies
Prof. C. Raghava Reddy	Centre for Knowledge, Culture & Innovation Studies
Prof. Deepa Srinivas	Centre for Women's Studies
Prof. K. Yesu Ratnam	Centre for Ambedkar Studies
Prof. Ajaya Kumar Sahoo	Centre for Study of Indian Diaspora
Prof. Aruna Bhikshu	Dance
Mr. Rajiv Velicheti	Theatre Arts
Dr. Baishali Ghosh	Fine Arts
Prof. E. Sathya Prakash Reddy	Communication

Prof. Vasuki Belavadi	Music
Dr. O. Sivasankar Prasad	Librarian I/c
PROFESSORS	
Prof. B. Sri Padmavati	Mathematics and Statistics
Prof. R. Radha	Mathematics and Statistics
Prof. Sachinkumar Balasaheb Bhalekar	Mathematics and Statistics
Prof. Chakravarthy Bhagvati	Computer and Information Sciences
Prof. Atul Negi	Computer and Information Sciences
Prof. Alok Singh	Computer and Information Sciences
Prof. Vineet C Padmanabhan Nair	Computer and Information Sciences
Prof. Rajeev Wankar	Computer and Information Sciences & Professor i/C, CMSD
Prof. Salman Abdul Moiz	Computer and Information Sciences & Director, CDLTR
Prof. K. Swarupa Rani	Computer and Information Sciences
Prof. P.S.V.S. Sai Prasad	Computer and Information Sciences
Prof. Satish Narayana Srirama	Computer and Information Sciences
Prof. Srinivasa Rao Battula	Computer and Information Sciences
Prof. N. Rukma Rekha	Computer and Information Sciences
Porf. S. Nagender Kumar	Computer and Information Sciences
Prof. Suneel Singh	Physics
Prof. Nirmal Kumar Viswanathan	Physics
Prof. Venkataiah Gorige	Physics
Prof. Rukmani Mohanta	Physics
Prof. E. Harikumar	Physics
Prof. V. Subrahmanyam	Physics
Prof. Ajit Kumar Patra	Physics
Prof. Soma Sanyal	Physics
Prof. N. Sri Ram Gopal	Physics
Prof. K.C. James Raju	CASEST
Prof. S.V.S. Nageswara Rao	CASEST & Professor-in-Charge, Centre for Nano Technology
Prof. S. Venugopal Rao	ACRHEM
Prof. Anil Kumar Chaudhary	ACRHEM
Prof. Karumuri Ashok	CEOAS

Prof. Samar Kumar Das	Chemistry
Prof. D.B.Ramachary	Chemistry
Prof. Pradeepta Kumar Panda	Chemistry
Prof. R.Balamurugan	Chemistry
Prof. Akhila Kumar Sahoo	Chemistry
Prof. K. Muralidharan	Chemistry
Prof. Srinivasarao Yaragorla	Chemistry
Prof. Pijus Kumar Sasmal	Chemistry
Prof. Mrinal K. Bhattacharyya	Biochemistry
Prof. Sharmistha Banerjee	Biochemistry
Prof. Pakala Suresh Bau	Biochemistry
Prof. Bramanandam Manavathi	Biochemistry & Director, Office for International Affairs
Prof. Gutti Ravi Kumar	Biochemistry
Prof. Sanotsh Kumar Padhi	Biochemistry
Prof. Gudipalli Padmaja	Plant Science
Prof. S. Rajagopal	Head
Prof. Yelam Sreenivasulu	Plant Sciences
Prof. Santosh R. Kanade	Plant Sciences
Prof. Irfan Ahmad Ghazi	Plant Sciences
Prof. Rahul Kumar	Plant Sciences
Prof. Sribash Roy	Plant Sciences
Prof. B. Senthilkumaran	Animal Biology
Prof. Anita Jagota	Animal Biology
Prof. Radheshyam Maurya	Animal Biology
Prof. Sreenivasulu Kurukuti	Animal Biology
Prof. Suresh Yenugu	Animal Biology
Prof. Nooruddin khan	Animal Biology
Prof. M.K. Aruna Sree	Animal Biology
Prof. K. P.M.S.V. Padmasree	Biotechnology and Bioinformatics
Prof. J.S.S. Prakash	Biotechnology and Bioinformatics
Prof. Vaibhav Vindal	Biotechnology and Bioinformatics
Prof. N. Prakash Prabhu	Biotechnology and Bioinformatics
Prof. Sunanda Bhattacharya	Biotechnology and Bioinformatics
Prof. Seema Mishra	Biochemistry
Prof. Mohd. Akif	Biochemistry
Prof. Akash Gulyani	Biochemistry
Prof. Anna Kurian	English

Prof. D. Murali Manohar	English
Prof. Laxminarayan Lenka	Philosophy
Prof. V. Krishna	Hindi
Prof. Gajendra Kumar Pathak	Hindi
Prof. M. Anjaneyulu	Hindi
Prof. Pammi Pavan Kumar	Telugu
Prof. Darla Venkateswara Rao	Telugu
Prof. Palepu Varija Rani	Telugu
Prof. Triveni Vangari	Telugu
Prof. Bhukya Thirupathi	Telugu
Prof. Arshia Jabeen	Urdu
Prof. Abdur Rab Manzar	Urdu
Prof. Zahidul Haque	Urdu
Prof. K. Rajyarama	CALTS
Prof. Kaveri Narayanrao Jadhav	Sanskrit Studies
Prof. R.V. Ramana Murthy	Economics
Prof. B. Nagarjuna	Economics
Prof. G. Sridevi	Economics
Prof. Alok Kumar Mishra	Economics
Prof. Jajati Keshari Parida	Economics
Prof. Srijit Mishra	Economics
Prof. Bhangya Bhukya	History
Prof. Y. Swarupa R. Shankar	History
Prof. Sujith Kumar Parayil	History
Prof. B. Eswara Rao	History
Prof. Kham Khan Suan Hausing	Political Science
Prof. K.K. Kailash	Political Science
Prof. E. Venkatesu	Political Science
Prof. Biju. B. L	Political Science
Prof. L. Lam Khan Piang	Sociology
Prof. V. Janardhan	Sociology
Prof. Satyapriya Rout	Sociology
Prof. Apparao Thamminaina	Anthropology
Prof. Ajailiu Niumai	CSSEIP
Prof. J. Rani Ratna Prabha	CSSEIP
Prof. Kanchan K. Malik	Communication
P. Thirumal	Communication
Prof. Irala Lokananda Reddy	Management Studies

Prof. Chetan Srivastava	Management Studies
Prof. R. Prasantha Kumar	Management Studies
Prof. D.V. Srinivasa Kumar	Management Studies
Prof. B. R. Shamanna	Medical Sciences & Chairman, Empowered Committee for Differently Abled Persons (ECDAP)
Prof. Athar Habib Siddiqui	Medical Sciences
Prof. Katta Ajitha	Medical Science
Prof. Suvashisa Rana	Psychology
Prof. V. Koteswara Rao Rajulapati	SEST
Prof. Raj Kishora Dash	SEST
Prof. S. Sudhakar babu	HRDC
ASSOCIATE PROFESSORS	
Dr. K. Sapna Singh	School of Management Studies
ASSISTANT PROFESSORS	
Dr. S Limakumba Walling	School of Economics
Dr. N. Annavaram	Department of Sociology, School of Social Sciences
Dr. D. Vijaya Kumari	Department of Telugu, School of Humanities
SPECIAL INVITEES	
Prof. S. Jeelani	Director, CD & VL
Prof. Vineet C.P. Nair	Chief Warden, Hostel Dept.
STUDENT REPRESENTATIVE	
Ms. Anisha Bodapati, Reg.No. 25CCPC02, Ph.D. Cognitive Science	Centre for Neural & Cognitive Science, School of Medical Sciences
STUDENT OBSERVERS	
Mr. Shiva Palepu Ph.D. Animal Biology Reg.No.22LAPH09	President, Students' Union
Ms. Shruti Priya Ph.D. Economics Reg.No. 24SEPH23	General Secretary, Students' Union

The Vice-Chancellor & Chairperson of the Council extended a warm welcome to all the members of the Academic Council and introduced the new members to the Council.

The Chairperson thanked the members whose term on the Council was completed and expressed appreciation for the services rendered by them to the Council.

Then the agenda was taken up for discussion.

Item No.AC:97:2026:01:

1.1. Confirmation of the Minutes of the 96th AC meeting.

Since no comments/observations have been received from the members, the Minutes of the 96th meeting of the Academic Council held on 03rd October, 2025 have been confirmed.

1.2. Action Taken Report on the Minutes of the 96th Academic Council meeting.

The action taken on the Minutes of the 96th meeting of the Academic Council held on 03rd October, 2025 have been noted by the Council.

The Council was informed by the Controller of Examinations i/c that all the efforts are being made to see that the admission counselling for all P.G. programmes are held online through the SAMARTH portal for the July session of Academic Year 2026-27.

REPORTING ITEMS

Item No.AC:97:2026:02: Letters/Public Notices and Regulations received from the UGC/MoE/AICTE/NTA/NCTE, etc.,

(i) The important letters/public notices and regulations received from UGC/MoE/AICTE/NTA/NCTE etc. presented in the Agenda item have been noted by the Council. With regard to the letter received from the Joint Secretary, Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment for establishment of Dr. Ambedkar Centre of Excellence(DACE) at UOH under the Scheme of "Free Coaching for SCs, OBCs and beneficiaries of PM CARES Children Scheme", the Dean, Student's Welfare informed the Council that the Committee for implementation of DACE has been set up and the recommendations of the same will be submitted to the Council during its next meeting.

(ii) Regulations issued by the UGC:

The Council resolved that a Committee may be constituted to examine for University level implementation of the UGC regulations- UGC (Minimum Standards of Instruction for the Grant of Undergraduate Degree and Postgraduate Degree) Regulations, 2025 dated 26/03/2025 and University Grants Commission (Recognition and Grant of Equivalence to Qualifications Obtained From Foreign Educational Institutions) Regulations, 2025 dated 04/04/2025.

Item No.AC:97:2026:03: Report on admissions to the January session and January Extension session of Ph.D. Programmes for the Academic Year 2025-26:

The report presented by the Controller of Examinations on admission to Ph.D. programmes for the January and January Extension session of the Academic Year 2025-26 was considered and approved by the Council.

It was further resolved that for the Ph.D. admissions of the A.Y. 2026-27, the academic units may opt for one of the following two modes of admission i.e.,

1. through UoH Entrance Exam or JRF * in July and January
2. through UGC NET/CSIR UGC NET in March and August

*Categories 2 and 3 will not be considered for this mode.

The Council reaffirmed its decision with regard to the rationalization of marks of NET qualified candidates. Accordingly, the method of rationalization of marks of NET qualified candidates will continue to be followed as per the Notification Dated 28/07/2025.

Item No.AC:97:2026:04: Payment of Scholarship under Direct Beneficiary Transfer (DBT) Mode by the Social Welfare Department of State of Telangana to SC category students from the Academic Year 2024-25 onwards.

In light of the G.O.Ms. No. 6, dated 06-09-2024 of Government of Telangana stating that the entire scholarship amount including the Tuition Fee (RTF) and Maintenance Allowance (MTF) pertaining to the SC students will be paid into the account of the students through Aadhar Payment Bridge System (APBS) by Direct Beneficiary Transfer(DBT) for implementation w.e.f 2024-25 academic year onwards, the Council reiterated its previous decision as notified by Circular dated 11/06/2025.

Thus, the students belonging to SC category shall not be entitled for concession in payment of fee despite the fact they may be drawing social welfare scholarships through TS ePass since they are not considered to be 'Scholarship Holders' in terms of norms of the University. Therefore, all SC category students are to pay full amount of fee at par with unreserved category from the academic year 2024-25.

The matter shall also be reported to the Finance Committee.

Item No.AC:97:2026:05: Non-compliance of minimum credit requirements per semester as prescribed by the NEP 2020.

The Council noted that as per NEP 2020, all UG/PG/Integrated PG students are required to complete a minimum of 20 credits per semester and 40 credits per academic year towards their degree/diploma. It was reported by the Controller of Examinations that some of the students were found to be deficient in this requirement and this fact was notified by a Notice dated 02/02/2026. The matter was noted by the Council with an advice to all the academic units to comply and

implement the same. It was also resolved that the GECs are not to be substituted for making up deficit credits.

ITEMS FOR CONSIDERATION

Item No.AC:97:2026:06: Academic Calendar for the year 2026-27
After a discussion regarding the UGC Regulations regarding minimum teaching hours and teaching days in an Academic Year, the Council decided to refer the item back to the Committee for redrafting of Academic Calendar for the year 2026-27 by incorporating the suggestions made by the members for modifications taking into account the time required for internships for the students.

Item No.AC:97:2026:07: Prospectus for the Academic Year 2026-27
The Council noted the Prospectus 2026-27 and changes are to be submitted within a week days for incorporation and publication on the website.

Item No.AC:97:2026:08: Wards of Defence Personnel quota in PG/Int PG admissions - Implementation of priority of category within the DP quota.
The priority list vide Ministry of Defence letter No. F.No.6(1)/2017/D/(Res.11), dated May 21, 2018 for the supernumerary seats for Wards of Defence Personnel is approved by the Council for implementation from Academic Year 2026-27. Accordingly, the merit list shall be drawn from within the candidates of respective categories in the following order.

Priority I. Widows/Wards of Defence personnel killed in action

Priority II. Wards of Defence Personnel disabled in action and boarded out from service with disability attributable to military service.

Priority III. Widows/Wards of Defence Personnel who died while in peace time with death attributable to military service.

Priority IV. Wards of Defence Personnel disabled in service and boarded out with disability attributable to military service.

Priority V. Wards of Serving/Ex-servicemen including personnel of police forces who are in receipt of Gallantry Awards.

(1). ParamVir Chakra

(2). Ashok Chakra

(3). MahaVir Chakra

(4). Kirti Chakra

(5). Vir Chakra

(6). Shaurya Chakra

(7). President,,s Police Medal for Gallantry

(8). Sena Medal (Gallantry), NauSena Medal (Gallantry), VayuSena Medal (Gallantry)

(9). Mention-in- Dispatches

(10).Police Medal for Gallantry.

Priority VI. Wards of Ex-Servicemen.

Priority VII. Wives of:

(i). Defence personnel disabled in action and boarded out from service.

(ii). Defence personnel disabled in service and boarded out with disability attributable to military service

(iii). Ex-servicemen and serving personnel who are in receipt of Gallantry Awards.

Priority VIII. Wards of Serving Personnel.

Priority IX*. Wives of Serving Personnel

Item No.AC:97:2026:09:Nomination of External Member to the Academic Council.
Members of the Council were requested to send the nominations whose candidatures may be considered by the Vice-Chancellor for nomination as external member on to the Council.

Item No.AC:97:2026:10: Conducting admissions for Ph.D. programmes two times in an academic year from 2026-27 based on mode of admission.
The Council noted that the admissions for Ph.D. programmes are being held currently twice a year i.e. in July and January and in two different modes, that is, through the entrance examinations and based on UGC-NET/UGC-CSIR-NET scores.

It was also noted by the Council that the exams for UGC-NET/UGC-CSIR-NET are held in December and June months every year and the results/ranks of the same are declared somewhere around in March and August months and due to mismatch with the schedule of NET exams and the admission schedule of the University, the candidates qualifying in these exams are not getting opportunity to apply for admission into the University of Hyderabad. Considering the above fact in view, the academic units which are opting for admissions based NET scores are desiring to align

the admission schedule of the University such that the candidates qualified in NET may submit their application immediately after the results of the same are notified.

Accordingly, the Council resolved that the Ph.D admissions from the A.Y. 2026-27 be held in two modes as under:

1. For the academic units which opt for the UoH Entrance Exam - in July and January respectively.
2. For the academic units which opt for the UGC NET/CSIR UGC NET - in March and August respectively.

The method of rationalization of marks of NET qualified candidates will continue to be followed as per the Notification Dated 28/07/2025.

The Controller of Examinations had informed the Council that the Academic Units have submitted the mode of admission through a form circulated by the CE's Office. Accordingly, the 28 Ph.D. programmes for which the admissions are through UoH Entrance Examination are

S.No.	**Programme**	**S.No.**	**Programme**
1	Ph.D. Physics	15	Ph.D. Sociology
2	Ph.D. Earth, Ocean and Atmospheric Sciences	16	Ph.D. Anthropology
3	Ph.D. Biochemistry	17	Ph.D. Education
4	Ph.D. Plant Sciences	18	Ph.D. Regional Studies
5	Ph.D. Animal Biology	19	Ph.D. Folk Culture Studies
6	Ph.D. Biotechnology	20	Ph.D. Social Inclusion Studies
7	Ph.D. Bioinformatics	21	Ph.D. Indian Diaspora
8	Ph.D. Telugu	22	Ph.D. Gender Studies

S.No.	Programme	S.No.	Programme
9	Ph.D. Urdu	23	Ph.D. Dance
10	Ph.D. Comparative Literature	24	Ph.D. Communication
11	Ph.D. Sanskrit Studies	25	Ph.D. Music
12	Ph.D. English Language Studies	26	Ph.D. Health Sciences :Optometry and Vision Sciences
13	Ph.D. History	27	Ph.D. Materials Engineering
14	Ph.D. Political Science	28	Ph.D. Nanoscience and Technology

The 17 Ph.D. Programmes for which the admissions are through UGC-NET/CSIR-UGC-NET scores are

S.No.	Programme
1	Ph.D.Mathematics
2	Ph.D. Applied Mathematics
3	Ph.D. Computer Science
4	Ph.D. Electronics Sciences and Engineering
5	Ph.D. Chemistry
6	Ph.D. Systems and Computational Biology
7	Ph.D. English
8	Ph.D. Philosophy
9	Ph.D. Hindi
10	Ph.D. Economics
11	Ph.D. Management Studies
12	Ph.D. Health Sciences : Public Health
13	Ph.D. Health Sciences :Biomedical Sciences

14	Ph.D. Psychology
15	Ph.D. Cognitive Science
16	Ph.D. Applied Linguistics
17	Ph.D. Translation Studies

Item No.AC:97:2026:11: Merger of CDLTR into CDVL.
The recommendations of the Committee for the Merger of CDLTR into CDVL have been approved by the Council.
The Council approved the constitution of a Committee for Internal Quality Assessment (CIQA) to operationalize the activities of CDOE.

MINUTES OF THE SCHOOL BOARDS

Item No.AC:97:2026:12: Minutes of the 22nd Meeting of School Board of School of Computer and Information Sciences held on 19/01/2026.

Item No.AC:97:2026:12.1: Implementation of Zero backlogs for Integrated M.Tech students to be eligible for promotion from 4th Semester onwards:
(SB Item No. SB:22:I:VII (i))
The Council noted that the School Board recommended implementing a "zero backlog" policy for the students of Integrated M.Tech. whereby the students who will be having backlogs by the end of 4th semester may not be promoted to the 5th semester. The Council, apart from considering the data pertaining to the last three academic years presented by the Dean, SCIS, considered the facts and circumstances under which the School is proposing a 'zero backlog policy'.

The Council, after a detailed discussion, resolved to advise the Dean, SCIS to explore the possibility of offering a summer semester every year to the students with backlogs so that it can help them reduce backlogs and progress in their academic career. The Council advised the Dean, SCIS to report back to the Council for a review on efficacy of summer semester so that an appropriate decision in this regard may be taken.

Item No.AC:97:2026:12.2:Uniform Grading Slab for I.M.Tech Students
(SB Item No. SB:22:I:VII (ii))
The Council discussed the proposition of the SCIS to bring in change in the grading system for the I.M.Tech. programme wherein two different grading slabs proposed to be applied as under:

a) The first 3 years of I.M.Tech grading are at par with MCA and the last 2 years at par with the grading of the M.Tech programme.

b) Since the I.M.Tech. is a combination of UG and PG programmes and no specific guidelines have been prescribed by the AICTE yet regarding the gradings to be followed at UG level, the School proposes to fix the minimum pass marks in the range of 40 to 49 for first 3 years as has been done in the case of MCA; and
c) Subsequent 2 years of their study be equated with the PG programme, i.e. M.Tech., and hence the range of marks of 50-54 be considered as 'Pass' grade since these I.M.Tech students are merged with M.Tech students.
d) The Council advised the Dean, SCIS to form a School Level Committee to inspect the AICTE guidelines and NEP 2020 grading slabs and to submit the report.

Item No.AC:97:2026:12.3: Ph.D admission criteria - Ph.D admission with GATE qualification:
(SB Item No. SB:22:I:VI (g) (ii))

The Academic Council approved the admissions to Ph.D. programmes with GATE scores as qualifying marks by scaling the GATE scores to 70 and interviews to be conducted for 30 marks. Similar scaling will be implemented for all departments that opt for Ph.D. admissions with GATE scores.

Item No.AC:97:2026:12.4:Proposal for Skill Development Programme:
(SB Item No. SB:22:I:VI (k))

The Academic Council approved the conduction of the Skill Development Programme proposed by the School of Computer and Information Sciences wherein students from other institutions also can undertake internships under faculty of SCIS. The program would also be open to University of Hyderabad students.

Item No.AC:97:2026:13: Minutes of the 62nd Meeting of School Board of School of Physics held on 25/02/2026.

Item No.AC:97:2026:13.1: Recognition of Dr. Amit Pratap, Scientist F, CHESS as external Ph.D guide by UoH.
(SB Item No. PHY-SB-62 (2026)20 CEOAS # 3)

The Council approved the proposal to recognise Dr. Amit Pratap, Scientist F, CHESS as an external Ph.D. guide and co-supervisor.

Item No.AC:97:2026:13.2: Scientists of INCOIS to serve as principal Ph.D. supervisors for external PhD students working in INCOIS
(SB Item No. PHY-SB-62 (2026)20 CEOAS # 5)

CEOAS has an MoU with INCOIS through which students access data, specialized facilities, internships, and joint research guidance from INCOIS scientists and CEOAS faculty. Since INCOIS

scientists are now allowed to serve as principal Ph.D. supervisors at other institutions, CEOAS has proposed a revised supervision framework wherein INCOIS scientists and UoH faculty serve as supervisors to strengthen collaboration and sustain academic engagement.

As per MOU established by UoH with INCOIS and UGC regulations, the external supervisors can be designated as co-supervisors only. The Council resolved to constitute a committee to examine the UGC regulations, alternative nomenclature for supervisors, and effect on the number of scholars being supervised per faculty as per UGC norms.

Item No.AC:97:2026:14: Minutes of the Meeting of School Board of School of Chemistry held on 06/02/2026.

Item No.AC:97:2026:14.1: Nomination of Prof. Samudranil Pal for Emeritus Professorship. (SB item: B/CHSB060226/1)

Nomination of Prof. Samudranil Paul for Emeritus Professorship for a period of 5 years w.e.f. 01.06.2026 is approved by the Academic Council and recommended to be placed in the next Executive Council.

Item No.AC:97:2026:15: Minutes of the Meeting of School Board of School of Life Sciences held on 24/02/2026.

Item No.AC:97:2026:15.1: Ph.D. Admission Pattern
(SB Item No.4)

The School of Life Sciences has proposed a Department specific admission pattern for admissions into Ph.D. programmes. The Council resolved to follow the University-wide admission pattern as notified on 28/07/2025 as per the resolution of the 95th Academic Council for admission to all Ph.D. programmes and as per the resolution of this meeting as at Item No. 10 above.

Item No.AC:97:2026:15.2: Change in criteria for Kambampati Srinivas Rao and Jaya Lakshmi Gold Medal
(SB Item No.7)

The change in criteria for Kambampati Srinivas Rao and Jaya Lakshmi Gold Medal from "candidate obtaining highest aggregate marks in all semesters among all Integrated M.Sc/Ph.D programs of School of Life Sciences" to "the overall topper in the Integrated Master of Science (I.M.Sc) Biology courses that the universities currently offers" from 2026-27 onwards is approved by the Academic Council and forwarded to the Executive Council.

Item No.AC:97:2026:16: Minutes of the Meeting of School Board of School of Humanities held on 26/02/2026.

Item No.AC:97:2026:16.1: Panel of Experts for faculty selection for Department of Urdu.
(SB Item No. HUM:SB:2026:12 (ii))
The Council recommended the panel of experts for faculty positions of the Department of Urdu for consideration and approval of the Executive Council.

Item No.AC:97:2026:17: Minutes of the Meeting of School Board of School of Social Sciences held on 03/03/2026.

Item No.AC:97:2026:17.1: Starting Dual degree program between the University of Hyderabad and University of Pavia:
(SB Item No. SB:72:2K26:I(15))
The 96th Academic Council had granted in-principle approval to the Department of Political Science for launching a Dual Degree programme in collaboration with University of Pavia, subject to submission and approval of detailed terms, conditions, and administrative modalities by the Vice Chancellor. The detailed proposal was placed before the Council and the Council approved starting a Dual degree program between the University of Hyderabad and University of Pavia from the A.Y. 2026-27 subject to completion of MoU.

Item No.AC:97:2026:17.2: Application of Prof. K.P.Rao for extension of Honorary Professorship for one year.
(SB item: SB:72:2K26:II(7)(Department of History))
The extension of Honorary Professorship of Prof. K.P. Rao for a period of 1 year is approved by the Academic Council and forwarded to the Executive Council.

Item No.AC:97:2026:17.3: Change in nomenclature of Ph.D. programme from Ph.D. in Social Exclusion and Inclusive Policy to Ph.D. in Social Inclusion Studies.
(SB by circulation)
Change in nomenclature of Ph.D. programme from Ph.D. in Social Exclusion and Inclusive Policy to **Ph.D. in Social Inclusion Studies** is approved by the Academic Council for implementation from A.Y. 2026-27.

Item No.AC:97:2026:18: Minutes of the 28th Meeting of the School Board of School of Economics held on 20/02/2026.

Item No.AC:97:2026:18.1: Increase in intake for IMA Economics programme from 19 to 30.
(SB Item SOE:SB:28/2026(Item No.10))
Increase in intake for IMA Economics programme from 19 to 30 is approved by the Academic Council for implementation from A.Y. 2026-27.

Item No.AC:97:2026:18.2: Change in Eligibility for M.A. Economics, M.A. Financial Economics, and Ph.D. Economics.

(SB Item Circulated through Email dt 17/03/2026)

Change in Eligibility for M.A. Economics, M.A. Financial Economics, and Ph.D. Economics as per NEP 2020 is approved by the Academic Council for implementation from A.Y. 2026-27.

Programme	Subject	Intake	Eligibility as per prospectus 2025-26	Revised Eligibility
MA	Economics	75	A Bachelor's Degree in Economics with at least 50% marks in aggregate and at least 50% marks in Economics; OR Bachelor's degree with at least 60% marks in any of the allied subjects viz. Commerce, Statistics, Mathematics, Engineering or any of the Social Sciences.	A Bachelor's Degree in Economics with at least 50% marks in aggregate and at least 50% marks in Economics; OR Bachelor's degree with at least 60% marks in any of the allied subjects viz. Commerce, Statistics, Mathematics, Engineering or any of the Social Sciences Disciplines.
MA	Financial Economics	37	A Bachelor's degree in Economics with at least 50% marks in aggregate and at least 50% marks in Economics; OR Bachelor's degree with at least 60% marks in any of the allied subjects viz. Commerce, Statistics, Mathematics, Engineering or any of the Social Sciences. AND Mathematics at + 2 Level.	A Bachelor's degree in Economics with at least 50% marks in aggregate and at least 50% marks in Economics; OR Bachelor's degree with at least 60% marks in any of the allied subjects viz. Commerce, Statistics, Mathematics, Engineering or any of the Social Sciences Disciplines; AND Mathematics/Mathematics for Economists/ Mathematical Economics/ Statistics/Quantitative Methods at + 2 level or at undergraduate level.

Ph.D	Economics	19	MA in Economics (with at least 55% marks or Equivalent Grade) OR Master's degree in the allied subjects (Commerce, Statistics, Mathematics, Engineering, and Management or any of the Social Sciences) with at least 55% marks or Equivalent Grade).	MA in Economics (with at least 55% marks or Equivalent Grade) OR Master's degree in the allied subjects (Commerce, Statistics, Mathematics, Engineering, and Management or any of the Social Sciences disciplines) with at least 55% marks or Equivalent Grade OR A four-year BA Honours (with Research) in Economics with 75% marks, OR Bachelors (Honours with Research) in allied subjects (Commerce, Statistics, Mathematics, Engineering, and Management or any of the Social Sciences disciplines) with 75% marks.

Item No.AC:97:2026:19: Minutes of the Meeting of the School Board of Sarojini Naidu School of Arts and Communication held on 18/03/2026.

Item No.AC:97:2026:19.1: Specializations for faculty vacant positions in the Department of Communication as on 31-12-2025
(SB item: 5(A-3))
The Council recommended the following faculty specialisation for consideration and approval to the Executive Council:

Vacancy : 1
Name of the position: Professor
Specialization: Communication & Media Studies/ Cultural Studies

Vacancy : 2
Name of the position: Associate Professor
Specialization: Video & Radio Production/ Print & Digital Media Production/ Communication & Media Studies.

Item No.AC:97:2026:19.2: Panel of Experts for faculty selection for Department of Theatre Arts.

(SB Item No. 6(B-1))

The Council recommended the panel of experts for faculty positions of the Department of Theatre Arts for consideration and approval of the Executive Council.

Item No.AC:97:2026:20: Minutes of the 46th Meeting of School Board of School of Management Studies held on 20/02/2026.

Item No.AC:97:2026:20.1: Revisiting the MBA (Business Analytics) Program, Suspending Admissions for some time to relaunch it after restructuring.

(SB Item No. II (1))

The School of Management Studies in its 46th School Board, recommended a proposal of discontinuation of MBA (Business Analytics) programme. A similar proposal was put forth in the 45th meeting of the School Board and subsequently the school was informed that suitable support from University shall be extended. Discontinuation of ongoing programs is strictly discouraged as it affects the University ranking.

Keeping in view the rankings and reputation of UoH, the suspension of the MBA(BA) programme is deferred by the Academic Council.

It was further resolved to forward the issue of criteria for utilization of School Development Funds to the Finance Committee for constitution of a committee to examine the same.

Item No.AC:97:2026:21: Minutes of the Meeting of the School Board of School of Medical Sciences held on 25/02/2026.

Item No.AC:97:2026:21.1: Panel of Experts for faculty selection for Optometry and Public Health.

(SB Item No. 6)

The Council recommended the panel of experts for faculty positions for Optometry and Public Health for consideration and approval of the Executive Council.

Item No.AC:97:2026:22: Minutes of the Meeting of School Board of School of Engineering Sciences and Technology held on 16/02/2026.

Item No.AC:97:2026:22.1: Recognition of External Supervisor from ARCI

(SB Item SB26.2)

Recognition of Dr. Naveen Manhar Chavan, Scientist - E, Centre for Engineered Coatings, as an External Supervisor to co-guide Ms. Kavyaa, research fellow of ARCI and Ms. Usha Sri, research fellow of SEST; both registered as PhD students at UoH is approved by the Academic Council.

Item No.AC:97:2026:23: Minutes of the Meeting of Board of Studies of the Centre for Integrated Studies held on 03/03/2026.

Item No.AC:97:2026:23.1: Conduct of Summer Semester.
(SB Item 9)
Conduct of Summer Semester by CIS is approved by the Academic Council for implementation for A.Y. 2026-27.

Item No.AC:97:2026:24: Any other items

1. To offer M.Tech program jointly by the CASEST and IIIT Hyderabad
(SB Item No. BoS-14 (2026) A-02)
Item dropped to obtain further clarification regarding usage of UoH logo and UGC Regulations regarding joint degrees.

2. To offer M.Tech. (Photonics) programme in collaboration between IIT-Hyderabad, TIFR-Hyderabad and the UoH.
(SB Item No. PHY-SB-62 (2026)19)
Item dropped as the detailed proposal was not furnished.

3. Introduction of Ph.D Programme in Music
(SB item: 5 (E-2))
The Academic Council has approved the introduction of Ph.D. programme in Music from the A.Y. 2026-27 with intake of 2 subject to condition that no additional resources be requested by the Department.

4. Implementation of B.Optom Programme under NCAHP guidelines
School of Medical Sciences (SB approval by circulation)
In compliance with NCAHP Act. 2021 and recommendations of the committee regarding the transition from existing Integrated M.Optometry(6-year) programme to B.Optometry(5-year) programme including mandatory clinical internship, the Academic Council has approved the launch of B.Optometry programme from A.Y. 2026-27 and **discontinuation of the Integrated M.Optometry programme**. The existing Integrated M.Optometry programme will be continued till the end of the programme for currently enrolled students only. The required compliance as per NCAHP Act 2021 must be met by the School of Medical Sciences.

5. Wards of Staff

The Academic Council resolved to write a letter to the Ministry of Education if the demands of Faculty and Non-Faculty staff for introduction of reservation to the wards of staff by allocation of supernumerary seats for admissions in the University of Hyderabad may be considered.

6. Concern regarding periodic review of services of employees

The circular regarding periodic review under Fundamental Rules 56(j) / (i) and rule 48 of the CCS (Pension) rules, 1972/2021, it was informed to the Academic Council that the above said letter from UGC was presented in the 193rd meeting of the EC only for information under important letters received from the UGC/MoE/GoI and not for implementation.

7. AI content checking

Currently, plagiarism check is being done by Turnitin software but no checking method is available for AI content. The Academic Council resolved to explore the methods for verifying AI content.

The meeting ended with a vote of thanks.

Vice-Chancellor
&
Chairperson, Academic Council